

Improving Conditions in Japan's Countryside

GD ⇒ hit Japanese farming and farmers hard

1932 ⇒ many farmers were heavily in debt

- struggling to pay their rent and taxes
 - and feed their families
- govt included range of measures to help farmers pay off their debts.
govt ⇒ increased public works in countryside to provide jobs for people

1932 ⇒ Ministry of Agriculture ⇒ launched campaign for economic revitalisation.

- campaign was a mix of propaganda and practical proposals ⇒ aimed to strengthen countryside

Campaign ⇒ stressed need to revive spirit of cooperation in rural areas.

→ also encouraged farmers to utilise scientific farming methods ⇒ instead of traditional ones

- farmers received guidance on how to better manage crops and finances on their farms.
- measures helped them to increase their income ⇒ and many farmers signed up for the campaign.
- government also presented success stories to motivate more farmers to take part

Conditions did not improve significantly ⇒ govt was more focused on industrialisation
